FREE STARTER GUIDE · 1 PAGE

Your first 5 things to try with AI

Pick one free chatbot, open a new chat, and paste the prompts below. Each task takes 5 to 10 minutes. Swap the [brackets] for your own details.

Before you start: pick one free chatbot

Any of these has a free version. Sign in with an account you already have:

- **ChatGPT** at chatgpt.com (has a free version)
- **Gemini** at gemini.google.com (free with a Google account)
- **Copilot** at copilot.microsoft.com (has a free version)

Don't paste passwords, bank details, medical records or other people's private information. Check anything important: AI can be wrong.

1 Fix an email you're dreading

Write a rough version in your own words, however clumsy, then paste it after this prompt.

```
Rewrite my draft email below so it's clear, polite and short. Keep my meaning and any dates or numbers exactly as they are. Give me two versions: one friendly, one more formal. Here's my draft:
```

2 Summarise a long email or document

Copy the text of a long email thread, report or letter. Paste it under this prompt.

```
Summarise the text below for me. Give me: 1) the main point in one sentence, 2) up to 5 bullet points with the key facts, 3) anything I need to do, with any dates or deadlines, 4) anything that's unclear or that I should ask about. Use plain English and quote the original wording for any number or date.
```

Then check the numbers and dates against the original.

3 Turn messy notes into a to-do list

Meeting scribbles, a voice-note transcript, a brain dump: paste it in as it is.

```
Turn my messy notes below into a clear to-do list. Group the tasks by topic, put the most urgent first, and add a deadline wherever my notes mention one. If something is vague, list it at the end as a question for me. My notes:
```

4 Plan a week of meals and a shopping list

```
Plan 5 simple weeknight dinners for [2 adults and 1 child]. Each should take under [30] minutes. We don't eat [mushrooms]. Reuse ingredients across meals so nothing goes to waste. Then give me one shopping list grouped by supermarket aisle.
```

Not happy with a meal? Reply "swap Wednesday for something with chicken".

5 Learn something, step by step

Anything you've been meaning to understand: a pension statement, a spreadsheet formula, a new hobby.

```
I want to understand [how a tracker mortgage works]. I'm a complete beginner. Explain it in plain English, one small step at a time. After each step, ask me a quick question to check I've got it before moving on.
```

Three habits that make every answer better

1. **Say who it's for.** "For my landlord", "for a 10-year-old", "for my manager".
2. **Reply, don't restart.** "Shorter", "warmer", "as a table" works better than a new chat.
3. **Check facts that matter.** Names, numbers, dates, prices and anything legal or medical.

More prompts and free automations: aistarthere.github.io

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